

TIMELINE

- November 1924** Born near Phan Rang in Ninh Thuan, Vietnam.
1945 Joins the Viet Minh.
1946 Runs away to Saigon; joins the Merchant Marine Academy.
1947 Secures place at the Vietnamese National Military Academy in Dalat.
1951 Marries Nguyen Thi Mai Anh.



NGUYEN THI MAI ANH

- 1954** Appointed major, leads battalion that drives communists from Phan Rang.
1956 Made head of the National Military Academy; holds post for four years.
1958 Converts to Catholicism.
November 1960 Helps to defend President Diem from an attempted coup.
October 1961 Commands the First Division, in Hue; given command of the Fifth Division, in Bien Hoa, in 1962.
November 1, 1963 Participates in coup that removes Diem from power.
November 6, 1963 Becomes a member of the ruling military junta.
June 1965 Becomes chief of state.
September 1967 Elected president of South Vietnam.
February 1968 Declares martial law in response to the Tet Offensive.
1968 Refuses to join Paris peace talks.
June 8, 1969 Meets with Nixon on Midway Island and is informed of first US troop redeployment.
1971 Re-elected president, apparently receiving 94 percent of the votes.
January 1973 Signs the Paris Peace Accord despite reservations.
1974 Launches offensives to regain territory taken by the NVA.
March 1975 Proves unable to defend against the final NVA offensive.
April 21, 1975 Gives a speech resigning as president of South Vietnam.
April 25, 1975 Flies to Taiwan; later settles in London, England.
1990s Moves to the United States.
September 29, 2001 Dies in hospital in Foxboro, Massachusetts.